

TaskBuddy

Chores, rewards and progress for families with children aged 10 to 16. This edition covers the Android app you have been invited to test, for both parents and children.

For closed-test participants

Covers Android app + web

Replaces manual v2.0 (web only)

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Why TaskBuddy exists

Almost every household with school-age children runs the same failed experiment. Someone draws up a chore chart. It works for about two weeks. Then it stops being updated, nobody can remember who did what, and the whole thing collapses back into asking three times and doing it yourself.

The chart is not the problem. The problem is that a chart records intentions and nothing else. It cannot tell you whether the bin actually went out, it gives a child nothing back for the effort, and it turns every disagreement into one person's word against another's.

The five things that actually go wrong

Nobody can prove what happened, so every week ends in an argument.

TASKBUDDY

Every task is submitted by the child and approved or returned by a parent. The record is kept, so "I did do it" stops being a matter of memory.

Effort is invisible. A child tidies up for a month and has nothing to show for it.

TASKBUDDY

Approved work pays experience points that fill a level bar and never go away, plus spendable points. Progress is visible on the child's home screen the moment a parent approves.

Pocket money is disconnected from contribution, so it stops meaning anything.

TASKBUDDY

Parents set the rewards and what they cost. Children choose what to save towards, and see exactly how far off they are.

Motivation collapses the first time a child misses a day.

TASKBUDDY

Streaks come with a grace period, and a long streak earns a freeze that absorbs one missed day automatically. One bad evening does not undo three weeks.

The apps that exist are built for five-year-olds or for office workers.

TASKBUDDY

TaskBuddy is built for 10 to 16 specifically. No sticker charts, no cartoon animals, and no project-management vocabulary either.

What we deliberately did not build

A rewards app can very easily turn into a slot machine. Two decisions push against that, and they are the ones we most want tested.

- **Games cannot out-earn chores.** The quiz games pay real points, but spendable points are capped at once per subject per day, and the amounts are set so that a full day of nothing but quizzes earns less than a normal day of chores. Playing instead of helping is not a winning strategy, by design.
- **There is no way to spend real money anywhere in the app.** Not on points, not on avatar items, not on anything. Every reward comes from a parent, and every cosmetic comes from points that were earned.

THE ONE-SENTENCE VERSION

TaskBuddy turns household chores into something a child can see themselves getting better at, and gives the parent a record instead of an argument.

If you are one of our testers

Thank you. TaskBuddy is in a **closed test** on Google Play, which means the app is not publicly listed and is visible only to the Google accounts we have added to the tester list.

Getting the app

1. Open the link from the invitation email **on your Android phone**.
2. Make sure the phone is signed in to Google with **the exact address the invitation was sent to**.
This is the single most common thing that goes wrong. On any other Google account the Play page will say the app is not available, which means the account is wrong, not that anything is broken.
3. Tap Install. There is no separate step to accept or confirm.

WHAT WE MOST NEED FROM YOU

Open the app on a few different days rather than exploring it thoroughly once. Google counts days with activity, and a habit app can only really be judged over a week. If something is confusing, that is a finding worth reporting, not a mistake on your part.

Reporting a problem

Whatever you can give us is useful. What helps most:

- What you were trying to do, and what happened instead.
- Whether you were the parent or the child at the time.
- Roughly when it happened, so we can find it in the logs.
- A screenshot, if the screen looked wrong.

Please read section 8 first. One thing is known to be missing in this build and is already on the list, so there is no need to report it.

How TaskBuddy works

The loop

A parent creates a task and assigns it to a child. The child does it in real life and marks it complete in the app. The parent gets a notification, opens Approvals, and either approves it or sends it back with a note. On approval the child immediately receives their **XP** and **points**, along with any level-up, badge, streak or team bonus that the approval triggered.

That cycle is the whole product. Everything else supports it.

Two currencies, on purpose

CURRENCY	EARNED	SPENT	PURPOSE
XP	On approval, and from games	Never	Fills the level bar. Permanent record of everything a child has done.
Points	On approval, plus level-up, streak, game and teamwork bonuses	In the reward shop and on avatar items	The spendable currency.

Keeping them separate means a child saving up for something expensive never has to choose between levelling up and buying it. Spending points does not cost them progress.

Who can do what

ROLE	SIGNS IN WITH	CAN
Parent	Email and password	Everything: tasks, rewards, approvals, children, settings, reports
Co-parent	Email and password	The same as a parent. Only the original account holder can remove a co-parent.
Child	Family code, username and a 4-digit PIN	Their own tasks, rewards, games and profile. No email address needed.

Android app or website

Both work, on the same account, at the same time. The Android app is what you are testing and it covers the whole loop, including photos. The website adds a couple of things the phone does not have, listed in section 8.

Parent guide PARENT

4.1 Creating your account

1. Open the app and choose **I'm a parent**, then **Create an account**.
2. Enter your name, email, date of birth, family name and a password. Passwords must be at least 8 characters, and we refuse any password known to have appeared in a public breach.
3. Verify your email using the link we send you.
4. A **family code** is generated for your household, in the style **MEGA-VIPER-8481**. Your children use it to sign in. You can see it any time under Children.

4.2 Confirming you are the parent

Before you can add a child, we need a verified record that a parent agreed to it. This is a legal requirement for holding data about children, and it is a one-off step for the whole family.

1. Fill in the add-child form as normal and submit it.
2. The app will tell you that confirmation is needed, and **send you the email automatically** at that moment.
3. Tap **Confirm I'm the parent** to see the status screen, where you can also send a fresh email if the first went astray.
4. Follow the link in the email. Come back to the app and add your child.

NOTE

The confirmation link is single-use and expires. If yours has timed out, just try adding a child again and a new email is sent.

4.3 The setup guide

A four-step guide walks you through adding a child, creating a task and approving it. The last step is worth doing rather than skipping: it seeds a task the child has already "finished" and hands you the approve button, so you see the full loop, with real points, in the first minute. Your progress is saved on the server, so you can close the app and a co-parent sees the same checklist.

4.4 The five tabs

TAB	WHAT IT IS FOR
Home	Approvals waiting on you, a card per child with level, points, streak and how they are tracking, current goals, recent comments, notifications
Tasks	Create tasks and browse everything assigned

TAB	WHAT IT IS FOR
Approvals	The queue of submitted work. A child cannot progress until you act
Children	Add and edit children, PINs, quiet hours, report cards, the family code QR and signed-in devices
Rewards	Create rewards and handle redemptions

Settings, Calendar, Insights, Reports, Co-parents and the consent screen are all reached from within those tabs rather than sitting on the bar, because six tabs do not fit comfortably on a phone.

4.5 Adding a child

From Children, tap **Add a child**. You will need:

- **First and last name.**
- **A username**, 3 to 20 characters, letters, numbers and underscore only. This is what they type to sign in, so two siblings both called Sam need different ones.
- **Date of birth.** TaskBuddy is for ages 10 to 16 and this is enforced.
- **A 4-digit PIN.** When editing later, leaving the PIN blank keeps the existing one rather than clearing it.

No email address is needed for a child, and they never receive email from us.

4.6 Getting your child signed in

From Children, open the **family code** screen. It shows a QR code and the code as text underneath.

- On a phone, your child taps **Scan my parent's code** and points their camera at it.
- If the camera is unavailable or refused, they can type the code instead. The QR is a shortcut, never the only way in.
- For the website, read the code out. Web child login has no QR.

The same screen lists signed-in devices for you and your children, and lets you sign a device out. Co-parents cannot be signed out from here, deliberately.

4.7 Creating tasks

- Give it a title, description and a points value. Difficulty follows from the points automatically.
- Choose **primary** (must-do) or **bonus**. Bonus tasks stay locked for a child until their primary tasks for the day are done.
- Optionally set a start time, an estimated duration and a due date.
- Assign it to one or more children.
- **Browse ideas** opens a library of ready-made chores grouped by age and room. Picking one fills the form and you can change anything before saving.

Team-up tasks

Assign two or more children to one job. Each child still earns the full points for their own work, and the teamwork bonus is paid on top, to everyone, once every member has been approved. Nobody earns less for co-operating and nobody is rewarded for going last.

Limits that are deliberate

- A child can hold at most **3 active assignments**, and only **1 primary at a time**. This is a focus guard, not a technical limit.
- If a new task overlaps something already scheduled for that child, you are shown the clash and can adjust or proceed anyway.
- Tasks can repeat daily, weekly, on weekdays or at weekends. New instances are generated automatically each night.

4.8 Approving work

You get a notification as soon as a child submits. Open Approvals, review what they sent, then approve or return it with a written note. Approving pays out everything at once: points, XP, level-up, badges, streak and any team bonus. Returning it puts the task back with your feedback so they can fix it and resubmit.

NOTE

If a co-parent has already handled a submission, the screen tells you who dealt with it rather than showing an error.

4.9 Rewards

- Set what each reward costs in points, how many times each child may claim it, and optionally a household-wide limit and an expiry date.
- **Browse ideas** offers ready-made suggestions ordered by what families actually redeem.
- A **collaborative reward** is funded by several children pooling points towards one goal. When you create it you choose who receives it: shared with the family, or one child you nominate once it is funded.
- When a child redeems something you are notified. Mark it fulfilled once you have actually delivered it.

4.10 Calendar, Insights and Reports

- **Calendar** shows the week with your children as columns, and flags two tasks that overlap for the same child.
- **Insights** answers what a table cannot: which days actually work for your family, which tasks are quietly never completed, and whether the points you award have drifted out of step with what your rewards cost.

- **Reports** covers task completion, the points ledger, redemptions, engagement and streaks, achievements, the leaderboard, overdue tasks, execution time and games.

REPORTS WORK DIFFERENTLY ON THE PHONE

In the app, Reports is a download screen: you choose the filters and it hands you a CSV or PDF to open or share. There is no on-screen chart or table. That is a deliberate decision rather than something missing. Use the website if you want to read a report on screen.

From a child's page you can also download a one-page **monthly report card**: their streaks, badges, growth against the previous month and a note from you. It is meant to be shared with a co-parent or a grandparent.

4.11 Notifications, quiet hours and schooltime

Settings controls which emails you receive. Separately, each child has a **quiet hours** window overnight and an optional **schooltime** window on chosen weekdays, during which their device will not buzz.

SET YOUR TIME ZONE FIRST

Quiet hours are read in your family time zone, so set that in Settings before relying on them. Notifications still arrive in the app during a quiet window, they simply do not interrupt, and nothing is delivered late in a burst afterwards.

TaskBuddy also limits itself: beyond one lifecycle email a day and three a week, further non-essential emails are held back. Account emails such as verification, password reset, consent, invitations and security notices are never held back, and neither is your Monday summary.

4.12 Settings and co-parents

- **Family code** — view or regenerate. Regenerating stops the old code working immediately.
- **Time zone** — used by quiet hours and schooltime.
- **Streak grace period** — extra hours past midnight that still count towards the previous day.
- **Leaderboard** — turn sibling rankings on or off for the whole family.
- **Daily game points cap** — the most a child can earn from games in one day.
- **Two-factor authentication** — add a one-time code from an authenticator app to your sign-in.
- **Invite a co-parent** — they receive a secure link valid for 7 days, and once accepted have equal access.
- **Webhooks and referrals** — send TaskBuddy events to another service, and share a referral link. Referrals earn a badge, never points.

Child guide CHILD

This part is written for you. TaskBuddy is where you pick up jobs, get them signed off, level up and spend what you earn.

5.1 Signing in

1. Open the app and choose I'm a kid.
2. Tap Scan my parent's code and point the camera at the QR code your parent shows you. The app will ask for camera permission at that moment, not before.
3. If there is no camera, or you would rather type, ask your parent to read the family code out.
4. Enter your username and your 4-digit PIN.

Your session stays signed in, so you do not have to do this every time. If you forget your PIN, tap Forgot PIN and your parent will be told.

5.2 Your five tabs

TAB	WHAT IS THERE
Home	Your level and XP bar, points, streak, today's tasks and your goal
Tasks	Everything assigned to you, plus bonus tasks you can claim
Rewards	What you can spend points on
Games	Quizzes that earn extra points and XP
Me	Badges, avatar items, ranking, your week and notifications

5.3 Doing a task

1. Open Tasks and read what is being asked.
2. Tap Start when you begin, so the time you spend is recorded.
3. Do the job in real life.
4. Tick it off. You can add a short note if you want to tell your parent something about it.
5. If the task asks for a photo, take one or pick one from your gallery before you send it.
6. It moves to waiting for approval until a parent reviews it.

PHOTOS

Some tasks ask for a photo so your grown-up can see the job is done. Tap **Take a photo** or **Choose a photo** in the box that appears when you tick the task off. If your phone will not let the app use the camera, you can still finish the task without one.

STATUS	WHAT IT MEANS
Pending	Assigned to you and waiting to be done
In progress	You have started it
Submitted	Waiting for a parent to approve
Approved	Done. Your XP and points have been added
Returned	A parent sent it back with feedback. Read it, fix it, resubmit
Overdue	The due date passed before it was completed

Primary and bonus tasks

Primary tasks are the ones that must be done. Bonus tasks unlock once your primary tasks for the day are finished, and you claim them yourself from the available list.

Team-up tasks

Some tasks are shared with a brother or sister. You each get the full points for your own work, and everyone gets the teamwork bonus once all of you have been approved.

LOST SIGNAL?

You can still start and complete tasks. They are saved on your phone and sent automatically when you are back online, so nothing is lost on a patchy connection.

5.4 Rewards

- Rewards you can afford are highlighted. The others show how many more points you need.
- Tap the heart to add something to your **wishlist**, so your parents know what you actually want.
- Set one as your **goal** and your progress towards it shows on your home screen.
- Tap redeem to claim it. Your points are deducted and a parent is told to deliver it.

Some rewards are shared, so you and your siblings can each put points in until it is paid for. A reward can also show as sold out if the family limit has been reached, or expired if its date has passed.

5.5 Games

Six subjects — maths, science, geography, vocabulary, grammar and puzzles — each at three levels: beginner, intermediate and hard. You can pick any level at any age. The questions rotate, so coming back tomorrow gives you a fresh set.

- You find out straight away whether an answer was right, and what the correct one was.
- Answers lock once chosen, so take your time.
- You need to get at least **3 out of 5** right for a game to pay anything at all. Below that, clicking at random earns nothing.
- Above that, points scale with how many you got right, and XP is paid in full.

HOW MUCH GAMES ACTUALLY PAY

Beginner pays **2 points**, intermediate **3**, hard **4**. Spendable points are paid **once per subject per day**. Play the same subject again and you still earn **XP**, just not more points. Your parents also set a daily cap on total game points.

Games are meant to top up what you earn from chores, not replace it. Review and history screens let you go back over questions you got wrong.

5.6 Me

- **Achievements** — badges unlock automatically when you hit a milestone.
- **Avatar items** — bought with points you earned. Wearing a new hat takes the old one off, but you still own it. Nothing here costs real money and nothing ever will.
- **Leaderboard** — how you and your siblings compare. Your parents can switch this off.
- **My week** — what you finished, your best day, your streak and new badges. Look for it at the weekend.
- **Notifications** — everything the app has told you.

5.7 Streaks

Your streak counts days in a row where you finished at least one task. Reach 7, 14, 30 or 100 days and you get a celebration. Keep a long streak going and you earn a **streak freeze**, which covers one missed day automatically. Your longest streak is always kept, even if the current one breaks.

Points, XP and levels

Everything that pays out, in one place.

SOURCE	POINTS	XP	NOTES
Approved task	Set by the parent	Scales with difficulty	Paid the instant a parent approves
Early completion	Bonus	—	Finishing ahead of the due date
Streak	Bonus	—	For consecutive active days
Level-up	Bonus	—	Each new level pays out
Team-up task	Full points each, plus a shared bonus	Yes	Bonus pays once every member is approved
Game	2 beginner · 3 intermediate · 4 hard	Yes	Points once per subject per day; later plays earn XP only. Minimum 3 of 5 correct. Family daily cap applies.

IF A BALANCE EVER LOOKS WRONG

Every single points movement is written to a ledger. The points ledger report shows exactly where each point came from and went, with a running balance.

Privacy and safety

- **Verified parental consent** is required before any child account can be created, and it is checked on the server every time, not just in the app.
- **Children have no email address** in TaskBuddy and are never emailed.
- **Photos a child submits are private.** They are stored so that only your family can retrieve them.
- **A child's chosen profile picture is held for parent approval** before it becomes visible.
- **No real-money purchases exist anywhere in the app**, and no advertising.
- **You can export everything.** A parent can download a full JSON bundle of the family's data.
- **Sessions are visible and revocable.** The devices screen lists every signed-in device for you and your children.

Parents are told plainly in the app that they can see when a child signs in and roughly what they do, because monitoring anyone without saying so is not something we are willing to do.

Known gaps in this build

One known gap, already on the list. No need to report it.

AVATAR ITEM ARTWORK

Avatar items show as their names rather than pictures. Buying, owning and equipping all work correctly; the artwork simply has not shipped yet.

Two more differences worth knowing, which are decisions rather than gaps:

- **Reports in the app download a file** rather than displaying on screen. See 4.10.
- **Children have no comment thread in the app.** They can add a note when completing a task, and comment threads are on the website.

Troubleshooting

Getting the app **PARENT**

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
Play says the app is not available	Your phone is almost certainly signed in to a different Google account. It must be the exact address the invitation was sent to
I cannot find the invitation	Check spam. Ask us to resend it

Parents **PARENT**

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
I cannot add a child	Parental consent has to be confirmed first. Submitting the form sends the email automatically; tap Confirm I'm the parent to check the status or resend
The consent email never arrived	Check spam, then open the consent screen and send a new one. The old link stops working when you do
My child cannot sign in	Check the family code under Children, and their username and PIN. Regenerating the code stops the old one working immediately
I forgot my password	Use Forgot password on the sign-in screen. New passwords must be at least 8 characters
A task has no photo	The child submitted without one. The app asks but does not force it, since a device can refuse the camera. Return the task and ask them to resubmit
My child got no notification	Check their quiet hours and your family time zone. The alert is still in the app
The team bonus was not paid	It pays only once every member has been approved, not merely submitted
Points look wrong	Download the points ledger report. Every movement is listed with a running balance
An email never arrived	Check spam, then Settings. Non-essential emails are also capped at one a day

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
The camera will not scan the code	Ask your parent to read the code out and type it instead. It works exactly the same
I cannot see any bonus tasks	Finish your primary tasks for today first
My task came back	Open it, read the feedback, fix it and resubmit
My points did not go up	Points arrive when a parent approves. Give it a moment, then refresh
The game gave me no points	You need at least 3 of 5 right. You may also have already earned points in that subject today, or hit the daily cap
I answered by accident	Answers lock once chosen. The next question is a fresh start
I lost my streak	A streak freeze covers one missed day if you have earned one. Your longest streak is always kept
A reward says sold out	The family limit was reached. Ask a parent whether it can be raised
My tasks will not submit	If you are offline they are saved and sent automatically when you reconnect
I forgot my PIN	Tap Forgot PIN . Your parent is told and can reset it

Glossary

TERM	MEANING
XP	Earned on approval and from games, fills the level bar, cannot be spent
Points	Earned on approval, spent in the reward shop and on avatar items
Level	A rank that rises as the XP bar fills. Each level-up pays bonus points
Streak	Consecutive days with at least one completed task
Streak freeze	Earned by keeping a long streak, covers one missed day automatically
Grace period	Extra hours past midnight that still count towards the previous day
Primary task	A must-do task. Bonus tasks stay locked until these are done
Bonus task	An optional task a child claims once their primary tasks are finished
Team-up task	One task shared by two or more children, with a bonus once all are approved
Family code	The memorable code children use to sign in, shown as text and as a QR
Co-parent	A second adult with equal access to the family account
Wishlist	Rewards a child has marked as wanted, visible to parents
Goal	The one reward a child is currently saving towards
Collaborative reward	A reward several children fund together
Quiet hours	A window during which notifications will not buzz a child's device
Schooltime	A second quiet window applying only on chosen weekdays
Badge	Unlocked automatically when a child reaches a milestone
Report card	A shareable one-page monthly PDF summary for one child
Parental consent	The verified record that a parent agreed, required before any child can be added